

D175

Consumer Behavior

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

Two days after buying a \$2,400 laptop from a big-box store with free parking, a graphic designer reads reviews praising a rival model and wonders whether he chose wrong. The store's return window is 15 days. Which stage of the decision process is he in, and what is he experiencing?

- A. Information search; he needs more data before buying.
- B. Post-purchase evaluation; cognitive dissonance.
- C. Evaluation of alternatives.
- D. Purchase stage, since he can still return it.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A car dealer sends buyers a thank-you note, a video praising the model's safety awards, and a service-plan reminder a week after purchase. What is the main goal?

- A. Reduce cognitive dissonance by reassuring buyers they made a good choice.
- B. Help buyers evaluate alternatives.
- C. Trigger need recognition for a new car.
- D. Build classical conditioning with the brand logo.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A shopper grabs the same brand of paper towels she has bought for years, spending less than ten seconds in the aisle. The store is running a promotion on patio furniture. What kind of decision-making is this?

- A. Routine response (habitual) decision-making.
- B. Impulse buying triggered by the patio promotion.
- C. Extended problem solving.
- D. Limited problem solving.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A luxury watch ad, filmed in Monaco with an orchestral soundtrack, shows a businesswoman receiving admiring looks from colleagues as she wears the watch. Which level of Maslow's hierarchy is the ad targeting?

- A. Self-actualization.
- B. Safety.
- C. Esteem.
- D. Belonging.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A soft-drink brand runs ads pairing its logo with upbeat songs from popular artists, so viewers come to feel happy when they see the logo. The campaign ran on 30 TV networks. Which learning process is this?

- A. Cognitive learning through problem solving.
- B. Operant conditioning.
- C. Media repetition, because it ran on 30 networks.
- D. Classical conditioning.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which marketing tactic relies on operant conditioning?

- A. A coffee shop gives a free drink after every ninth purchase.
- B. A store posts detailed spec comparisons.
- C. A perfume ad pairs the bottle with images of romance.
- D. A brand repeats its jingle on radio.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A college sophomore who works at a campus café buys the same trail-running shoes worn by professional ultramarathon runners she follows online, hoping to someday race like them. She lives in a dorm with three roommates. The pro runners are what kind of reference group for her?

- A. Membership group.
- B. Aspirational group.
- C. Her roommates, as her primary group.
- D. Dissociative group.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teenager refuses to wear a clothing brand because it is popular with a group he wants to avoid being linked with. What type of reference group is that group?

- A. Opinion leaders.
- B. Dissociative group.
- C. Aspirational group.
- D. Membership group.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A cereal maker sells a 20-ounce box and wants to shrink it without most shoppers noticing. Research shows the Weber fraction for package size is 0.08. The brand's mascot turns 50 this year. What is the largest reduction that should stay below the noticeable threshold?

- A. Just under 8 ounces.
- B. 18.4 ounces.
- C. Any amount, since shoppers never check package size.
- D. Just under 1.6 ounces.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Shoppers begin to notice a price increase on a \$60 item when it reaches \$63. What is the Weber fraction (k)?

- A.** 0.048
- B.** 3
- C.** 0.05
- D.** 20

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

In a family of four, the 12-year-old asks for a new gaming console after seeing it at a friend's house, the older sister argues for a specific model, the mother chooses which one to buy, and the father pays at checkout. The family lives in a two-story house. Who is the decider?

- A.** The 12-year-old.
- B.** The older sister.
- C.** The father, because he pays.
- D.** The mother.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A grocery chain with 60 stores in the Southwest stocks special foods and runs bilingual ads before a holiday important to its Hispanic customers. Its stores were recently repainted. What consumer-behavior concept is it applying?

- A.** Store atmospherics from the new paint.
- B.** Culture is inborn, so ads cannot change buying.
- C.** Subcultural marketing.
- D.** Personality-based segmentation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

Two days after buying a \$2,400 laptop from a big-box store ~~with free parking~~, a graphic designer reads reviews praising a rival model and wonders whether he chose wrong. ~~The store's return window is 15 days.~~ Which stage of the decision process is he in, and what is he experiencing?

Target word: stage and state **Decides:** Doubt after purchase.

A	Inverted operation	He has already bought; this is not pre-purchase search.
B	Correct	Doubt after a costly purchase is cognitive dissonance.
C	Adjacent category	That stage comes before purchase.
D	Camouflage	The return window does not move him back to the purchase stage.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

A car dealer sends buyers a thank-you note, a video praising the model's safety awards, and a service-plan reminder a week after purchase. What is the main goal?

Target word: reverse: purpose of the tactic **Decides:** Reassurance after purchase.

A	Correct	Post-purchase reassurance targets doubt.
B	Adjacent category	The choice has already been made.
C	Inverted operation	They just bought; the tactic looks back, not forward to a new need.
D	Confusion set	Not a pairing of stimuli; it is reassurance.

3. Answer A Concept 2

A shopper grabs the same brand of paper towels she has bought for years, spending less than ten seconds in the aisle. ~~The store is running a promotion on patio furniture.~~ What kind of decision-making is this?

Target word: problem-solving type **Decides:** Low-cost, frequent, habitual purchase.

A	Correct	Low-involvement repeat purchases are made by habit.
B	Camouflage	The promotion is for a different product.
C	Inverted operation	That is for costly, risky, rare purchases.
D	Adjacent category	Involves some comparison; she compared nothing.

4. Answer C Concept 3

A luxury watch ad, ~~filmed in Monaco with an orchestral soundtrack~~, shows a businesswoman receiving admiring looks from colleagues as she wears the watch. Which level of Maslow's hierarchy is the ad targeting?

Target word: need level **Decides:** Admiration and status.

A	Inverted operation	Self-actualization is inner fulfillment, not others' admiration.
B	Confusion set	Safety concerns security and protection.
C	Correct	Status, recognition and respect are esteem needs.
D	Adjacent category	Belonging is acceptance and love, not admiration.

5. Answer D Concept 4

A soft-drink brand runs ads pairing its logo with upbeat songs from popular artists, so viewers come to feel happy when they see the logo. ~~The campaign ran on 30 TV networks.~~ Which learning process is this?

Target word: name the learning process **Decides:** A feeling transferred by pairing a brand with a stimulus.

A	Adjacent category	No reasoning is involved; the link is associative.
B	Confusion set	Operant learning rewards a behavior after it occurs.
C	Camouflage	Reach helps exposure but does not name the learning process.
D	Correct	Pairing the logo with music that already produces a feeling.

6. Answer A Concept 4 • transfer

Which marketing tactic relies on operant conditioning?

Target word: reverse: pick the example **Decides:** Reward follows the behavior.

A	Correct	Rewarding repeat buying reinforces the behavior.
B	Confusion set	Supports cognitive learning.
C	Inverted operation	Pairing stimuli is classical conditioning.
D	Adjacent category	Repetition builds recall, not reinforcement.

7. Answer B Concept 5

A college sophomore ~~who works at a campus café~~ buys the same trail-running shoes worn by professional ultramarathon runners she follows online, hoping to someday race like them. ~~She lives in a dorm with three roommates.~~ The pro runners are what kind of reference group for her?

Target word: classify the group **Decides:** A group she wants to join but does not belong to.

A	Adjacent category	She does not belong to the pro group.
B	Correct	She hopes to be like them.
C	Camouflage	Roommates are not the group in question.
D	Inverted operation	Dissociative groups are ones people avoid.

8. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

A teenager refuses to wear a clothing brand because it is popular with a group he wants to avoid being linked with. What type of reference group is that group?

Target word: reverse: name the group type **Decides:** A group he avoids.

A	Confusion set	Opinion leaders are trusted sources, not a group avoided.
B	Correct	People avoid products tied to groups they reject.
C	Inverted operation	Aspirational groups are ones people want to join.
D	Adjacent category	He does not belong to it.

9. Answer D Concept 6

A cereal maker sells a 20-ounce box and wants to shrink it without most shoppers noticing. Research shows the Weber fraction for package size is 0.08. ~~The brand's mascot turns 50 this year.~~ What is the largest reduction that should stay below the noticeable threshold?

Target word: just noticeable difference **Decides:** $JND = 0.08 \times 20 \text{ oz} = 1.6 \text{ oz}$.

A	Wrong stem number	Reads 0.08 as 8 ounces.
B	Confusion set	That is the smallest new box size, not the size of the reduction.
C	Absolute language	Changes above the JND are noticed.
D	Correct	Changes smaller than $0.08 \times 20 = 1.6 \text{ oz}$ are unlikely to be noticed.

10. Answer C Concept 6 · transfer

Shoppers begin to notice a price increase on a \$60 item when it reaches \$63. What is the Weber fraction (k)?

Target word: solve for k **Decides:** $k = \Delta I \div I = \$3 \div \60 .

A	Confusion set	Divides by the new price, \$63, instead of the original.
B	Wrong stem number	The dollar change, not the ratio.
C	Correct	$\$3 / \$60 = 0.05$.
D	Inverted operation	Divides \$60 by \$3.

11. Answer D Concept 7

In a family of four, the 12-year-old asks for a new gaming console after seeing it at a friend's house, the older sister argues for a specific model, the mother chooses which one to buy, and the father pays at checkout. ~~The family lives in a two-story house.~~ Who is the decider?

Target word: identify the role **Decides:** The mother chooses.

A	Confusion set	He is the initiator (and a user).
B	Inverted operation	She influences but does not decide.
C	Adjacent category	Paying makes him the buyer, not the decider.
D	Correct	The decider makes the final choice.

12. Answer C Concept 8

A grocery chain with 60 stores in the Southwest stocks special foods and runs bilingual ads before a holiday important to its Hispanic customers. ~~Its stores were recently repainted.~~ What consumer-behavior concept is it applying?

Target word: name the concept **Decides:** Targeting a distinct group within the broader culture.

A	Camouflage	Paint is irrelevant to the concept applied.
B	Absolute language	Culture is learned and shapes buying.
C	Correct	Adapting to a subculture's shared values and traditions.
D	Adjacent category	Personality is individual, not shared group values.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	0	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	10	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	2	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	8	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Consumer decision process	Need recognition → information search → evaluation of alternatives → purchase → post-purchase evaluation; doubt after a big purchase is cognitive dissonance, reduced by reassurance.	Treating the purchase as the final stage and ignoring post-purchase doubt.	Where the buyer is: noticing a need, researching, comparing, buying, or second-guessing.
2	Involvement and problem solving	High-involvement purchases (costly, risky, self-expressive) trigger extended problem solving; low-involvement, frequent purchases rely on habit or routine response.	Assuming every purchase gets careful research.	Price, risk and frequency of the purchase.
3	Maslow's hierarchy of needs	Needs run from physiological to safety, belonging, esteem and self-actualization; marketers appeal to the level the product satisfies.	Labeling status or recognition appeals as belonging.	What the ad promises: survival, security, acceptance, status, or personal fulfillment.
4	Classical vs. operant conditioning	Classical conditioning pairs a brand with a stimulus that already triggers a feeling; operant conditioning shapes behavior with rewards or punishments after the behavior.	Calling a loyalty reward classical conditioning.	Is a feeling transferred by pairing, or is a behavior rewarded after it happens?
5	Reference groups and opinion leaders	Membership groups are ones we belong to; aspirational groups are ones we want to join; dissociative groups are ones we avoid; opinion leaders are trusted sources whose views spread.	Mixing aspirational and membership groups.	Whether the consumer belongs to, wants to join, or rejects the group.
6	Perception and the just noticeable difference	Weber's law: the smallest change people notice is a constant fraction (k) of the original level; $\Delta I = k \times I$.	Treating the noticeable difference as a fixed amount regardless of starting level.	A Weber fraction and a starting price or size.
7	Family decision-making roles	Family members may act as initiator, influencer, decider, buyer or user; one purchase can split roles across people.	Assuming the person who pays is the decider.	Different family members suggest, sway, choose, pay or use.
8	Culture and subculture	Culture is the learned, shared values and norms of a society; subcultures are groups within it with distinct values or practices that marketers can target.	Treating culture as inborn or as individual personality.	Shared values across a society or a distinct group within it.

Course scope (public description): Consumer Behavior examines the buying behavior of consumers in the marketplace. Students will gain knowledge of consumer behavior theories and an understanding of how consumer behavior concepts apply to the consumer decision-making process. Students will learn how consumer insights are

gained through the exploration of external social and cultural influences such as reference groups, family, and culture, as well as consumer influences such as needs, motivation, personality, and learning. The course also provides an interdisciplinary perspective, including psychology, sociology, anthropology, and economics, to better evaluate and predict consumer behavior.